

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on legal administrative and support experience across property disputes, caseload management and client-facing advisory work. At Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, supported the Real Estate Disputes team on leasehold, landlord and tenant, and property rights matters — preparing electronic bundles, managing matter files on iManage, tracking deadlines and handling court administration across competing matters. As Legal Adviser at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, manages a busy housing and property caseload from instruction through to submission, drafting correspondence, maintaining confidential records and communicating clearly with clients. Accurate, organised and well-suited to a fast-paced residential conveyancing team in Marlow.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in dispute resolution, procedural issues, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules in Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize — top 20 of a 200-student cohort; carried partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported the Real Estate Disputes team across landlord and tenant disputes, leasehold matters, rights of light and easements — conducting legal and factual research and preparing client notes
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court materials, skeleton arguments and court filings
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages a busy caseload across housing, welfare, employment, family and debt matters — taking detailed client instructions, establishing chronologies and identifying key legal and evidential issues
- Handles matters from initial instruction through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; communicates complex rules clearly and accessibly to individuals in stressful circumstances
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research; amended sections of the memorial
- Coordinated documents and tracked outstanding actions as the sole junior on the team ahead of a significant filing deadline — helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translation

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK and EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk; communicated amendments to stakeholders

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: iManage; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; document review; case management and time-recording systems; concise report and correspondence writing

Case and evidence management: Matter file management, hearing bundle preparation, document schedules, deadline tracking, case-file organisation, confidential document handling